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Psychedelic Research at the VA*

VA Offices of Research and Development (ORD) and Mental Health (OMH) work closely together to position VA to conduct psychedelic research and plan for potential future clinical implementation of psychedelic treatments.

VA researchers conduct psychedelic research funded by external sources and VA is beginning to fund research on psychedelics through its intramural research program.

Legal Status of Psychedelics

- ❖ No psychedelics are currently approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA).
- ❖ Several psychedelics have “breakthrough therapy” status from FDA (MDMA, psilocybin, LSD).
- ❖ Clinical use of psychedelic treatments beyond research will only begin once FDA approves.
- ❖ Research is conducted under strict safety protocols and in compliance with federal guidelines.

Current Clinical Trials with Psychedelics for Mental Health Conditions



16
Studies

\$23 M
External Funding

Location of Psychedelic Trials



Upcoming VA-Funded Clinical Trials

- ❖ MDMA-Assisted Therapy for Veterans with PTSD and Alcohol Use Disorder
- ❖ Multi-Site Trial of Psilocybin for Treatment-Resistant Depression
- ❖ Psilocybin-Assisted Acceptance and Commitment Therapy In Depressive Disorders

*As of November 2025